DiSC Workshop

Presented by:

Dr. Elizabeth Scott

Brighter Strategies

www.brighterstrategies.com

Exploring Working Styles

Individual & Group Activity

	1	2	3	4
A				
B				
C				
D				
E				
F				
G				
H				

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Choose the word that most often describes your first impulse at work
(not how you want to be)

A

1. Action-Oriented
2. Reach Out to Others
3. Provide Stability
4. Accuracy

B

1. Take Charge
2. Motivate Others
3. Minimal Conflict
4. Analytical

C

1. Gets results now
2. Optimistic
3. Patient
4. Detailed

D

1. Strong-willed
2. Imaginative
3. Loyal
4. Quality Control

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Choose the word that most often describes your first impulse at work
(not how you want to be)

E

1. Straightforward
2. Entertain Others
3. Good Listener
4. Private

F

1. Like Trying New Things
2. Sociable
3. Appreciate Routine
4. Very Organized

G

1. Direct
2. Persuasive
3. Accommodating
4. Cautious

H

1. Easily & Quickly Make Decisions
2. Like Group Decision Making
3. Works Behind the Scenes
4. Focus on the facts

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What does it all mean?

- Add up the words or checks you marked in each column (1,2,3,4)
- Tell us the 1-2 top numbers for you.

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Today’s Learning Goals

- Value of differences in others
- Understand our individual strengths
- Learn how behavioral impacts effectiveness
- Influence individual’s perspective
- Make interpersonal relationships better and more effective
- Explore ways to adapt behavior to meet the needs of the situation

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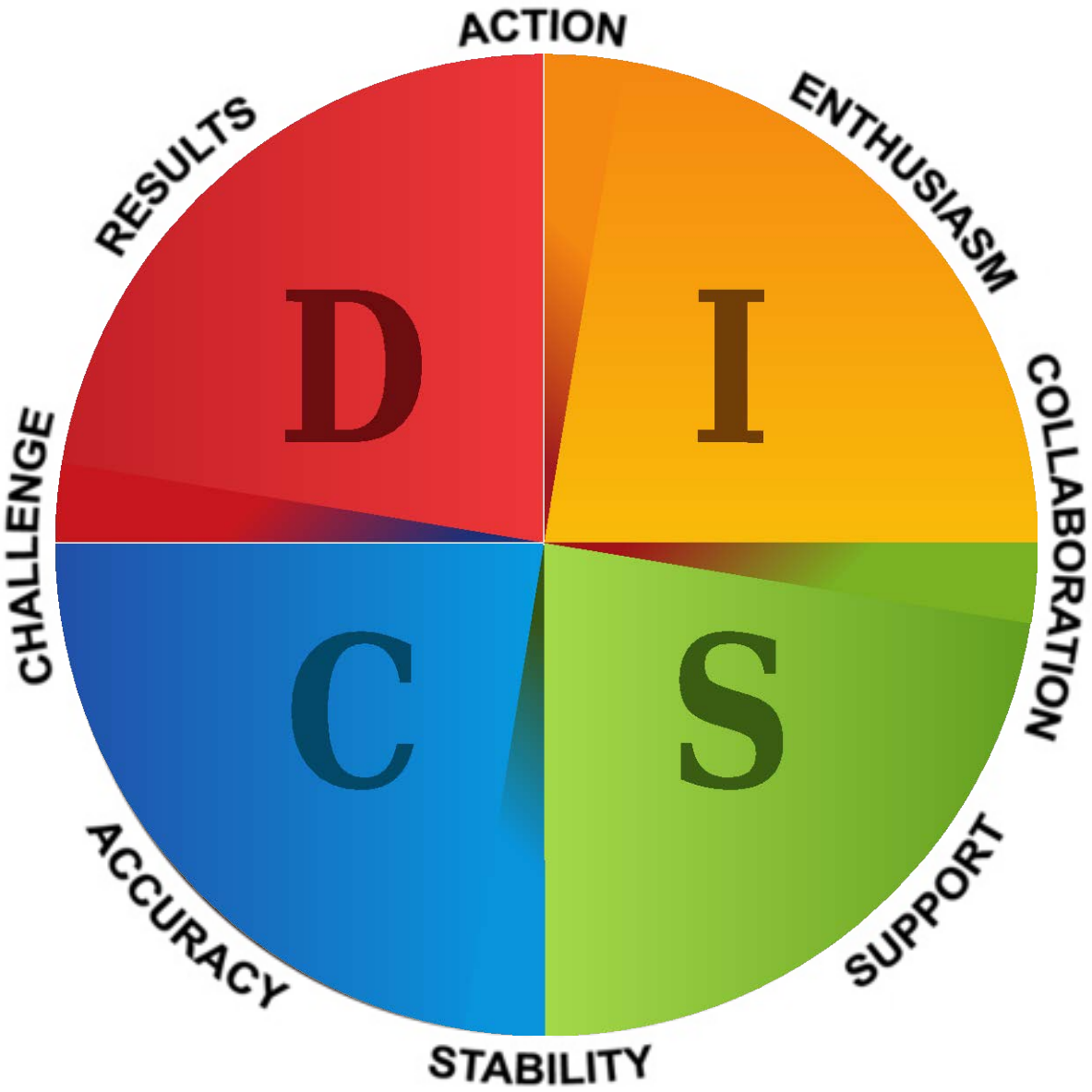
What is DiSC?

- Dr. William M. Marston (1920) interested in how normal people felt and behaved as they interacted with the world around them.
- Based on a four-dimensional model, divides behavior into four distinct dimensions: Dominance, influence, Steadiness and Conscientiousness (DiSC).



Why Use It?

- Tap into what motivates you, your employees, and your teams – do more, with less conflict
- Understand others to communicate more effectively and efficiently – put everyone on the same page
- Personal development, professional development, and a healthier workplace are good for everyone

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DiSC PROFILE

- There is no one best style
- There are positives and drawbacks of each style
- You have the choice to modify your style when dealing with others
- Under stress our dominate style tends to take over
- In a group of like styles, secondary styles may emerge more

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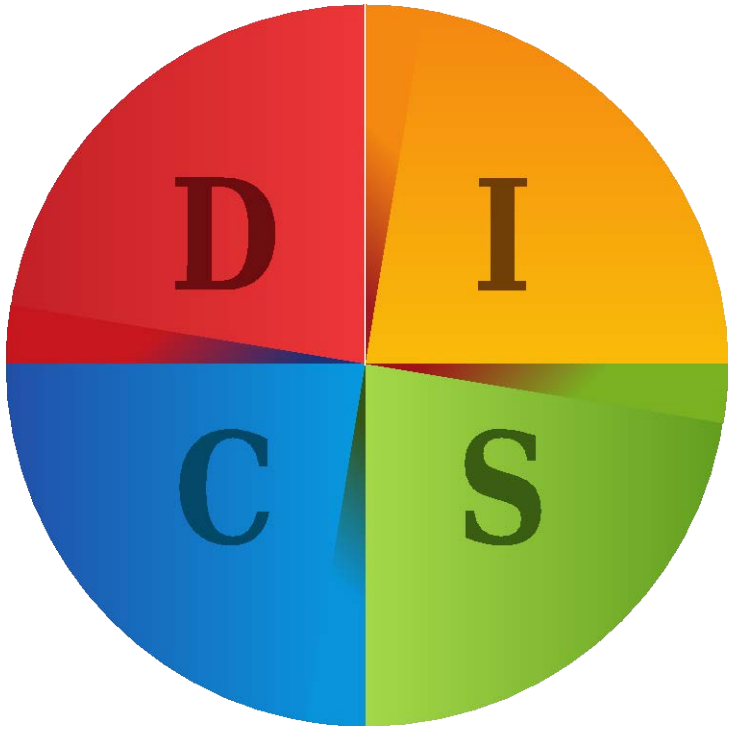
RELIABILITY



- Spearman Brown split halves reliability coefficient:
  - **Dominance (r=92%)**
  - **Influence (r=89%)**
  - **Steadiness (r=91%)**
  - **Consciousness (r=90%)**

DiSC MODEL

DOMINANCE

D

Active
Fast Paced
Assertive
Dynamic

INFLUENCE

I

Accepting
People-Focused
Empathizing
Receptive

CONSCIENTIOUSNESS

C

Questioning
Logic Focused
Objective
Skeptical

STEADINESS

S

Thoughtful
Moderate Paced
Calm
Methodical

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DOMINANCE

Emphasize: Shaping the environment by overcoming opposition and challenge

Tendencies: Getting immediate results; taking action; accepting challenges

Motivated by: Challenge; power and authority; direct answers

Fears: Loss of control; being taken advantage of

You will notice: Self-confidence; decisiveness; risk-taking

Limitations: Lack of concern for others; impatience ; moving forward without considering outcomes

Motto: Just Do It!

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DOMINANCE

Likes

- Activity
- Challenge
- Competition
- Debate
- Hard work
- Major productions
- To be in charge

Dislikes

- Indecision
- Talkers who don’t produce
- Activities without a goal
- Slow activities
- Lazy people
- Taking orders

INFLUENCE

D

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Fast Paced
Assertive
Dynamic

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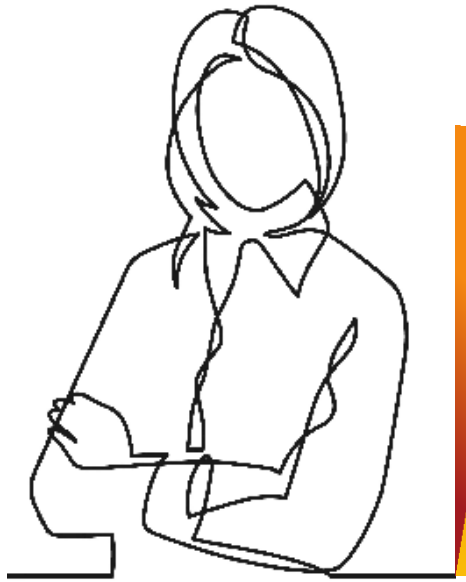

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INFLUENCE

Emphasize: Shaping the environment by persuading and influencing

Tendencies: Involvement with people; making a favorable impression

Motivated by: Social recognition; group activities; relationships

Fears: Social rejection; disapproval; loss of influence

You will notice: Enthusiasm; charm; sociability

Limitations: Impulsiveness; disorganization, lack of follow through

Motto: Don't Worry, Be Happy

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INFLUENCE

Likes

- Exposure to people
- Lots of activity
- Making people laugh/happy
- Short term projects
- To be on the go
- Prestige
- Selling…while they play

Dislikes

- Being ignored
- Being ridiculed
- Being isolated
- Doing repetitive tasks

STEADINESS

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Assertive
Dynamic

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STEADINESS

Emphasize: Achieving stability, accomplishing tasks by cooperating with others

Tendencies: Calm; patient; loyal; good listener

Motivated by: Infrequent changes; stability; sincere appreciation; cooperation

Fears: Loss of stability; the unknown; change

You will notice: Patience; a team player; stability, methodical approach; calm

Limitations: Overly willing to give; putting their needs last

Motto: Don't Rock the Boat

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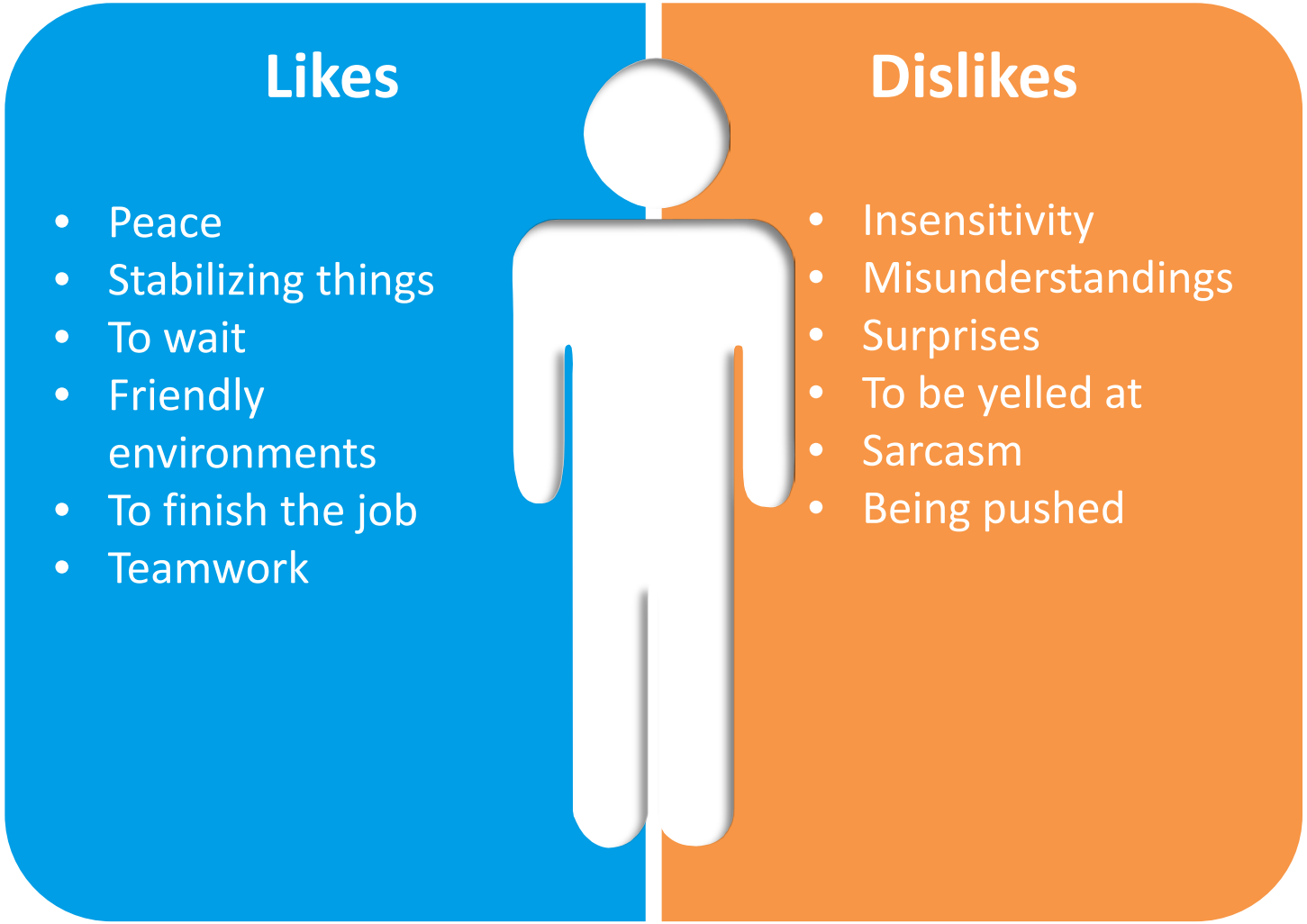
STEADINESS


Likes
Peace
Stabilizing things
To wait
Friendly environments
To finish the job
Teamwork
Dislikes
Insensitivity
Misunderstandings
Surprises
To be yelled at
Sarcasm
Being pushed

CONSCIENTIOUSNESS

D

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Assertive
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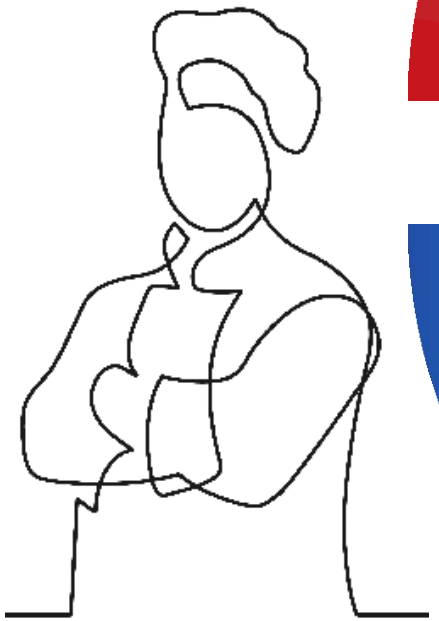

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CONSCIENTIOUSNESS

Emphasize: Working within circumstances to ensure quality and accuracy

Tendencies: Attention to standards and details; analytical thinking

Motivated by: Clearing defined performance expectations; quality and accuracy being valued

Fears: Criticism of their work; slipshod methods

You will notice: Behavior that is cautious, precise, diplomatic, restrained

Limitations: Overly critical of self and others; indecision due to wanting more data

Motto: Measure twice, cut once

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CONSCIENTIOUSNESS

Likes

- Consistency
- Detail
- Excellent work
- Creativity
- Perfection
- Getting it right

Dislikes

- Being criticized
- Unnecessary interruptions
- Ambition without a plan
- Mistakes
- Mediocrity
- Sudden changes

OVERVIEW OF DiSC

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VALUE OF UNDERSTANDING BEHAVIOR PROFILES

Create an environment most conducive to our success

Increase our understanding of other ways of behaving

Minimize potential conflict with others

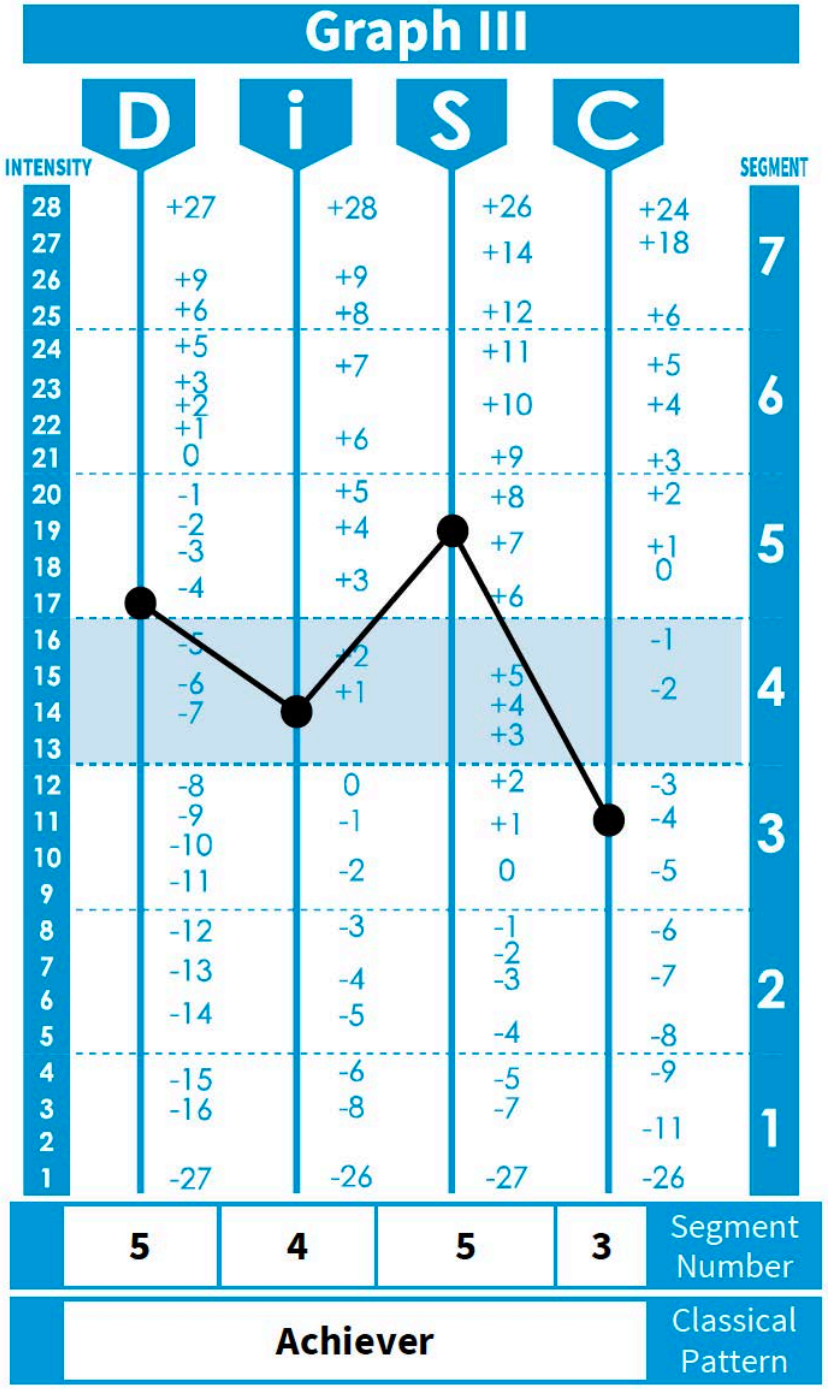
Maximize our potential for success

READING YOUR REPORT

Page 3 – Your DiSC Graph

Page 5 – Intensity Index (Strengths)

Page 10 – Classic Pattern



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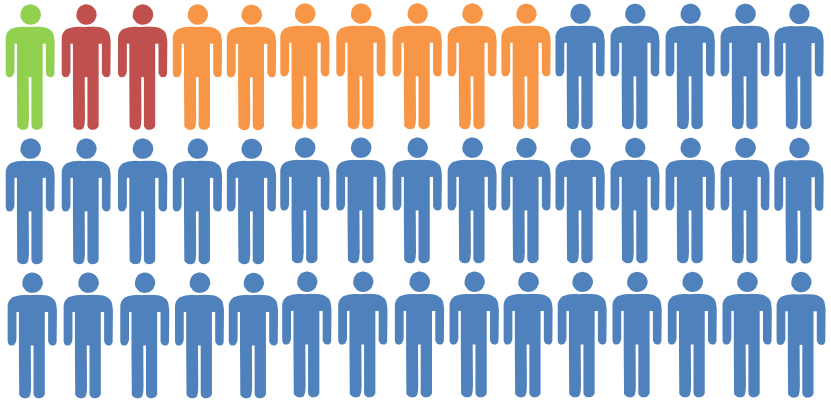
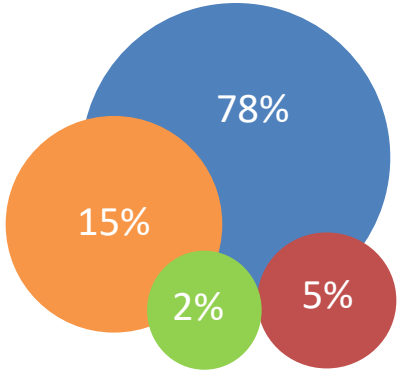
DiSC TENDENCIES





0 or all 4 tendencies

3 tendencies

1 tendency

2 tendencies

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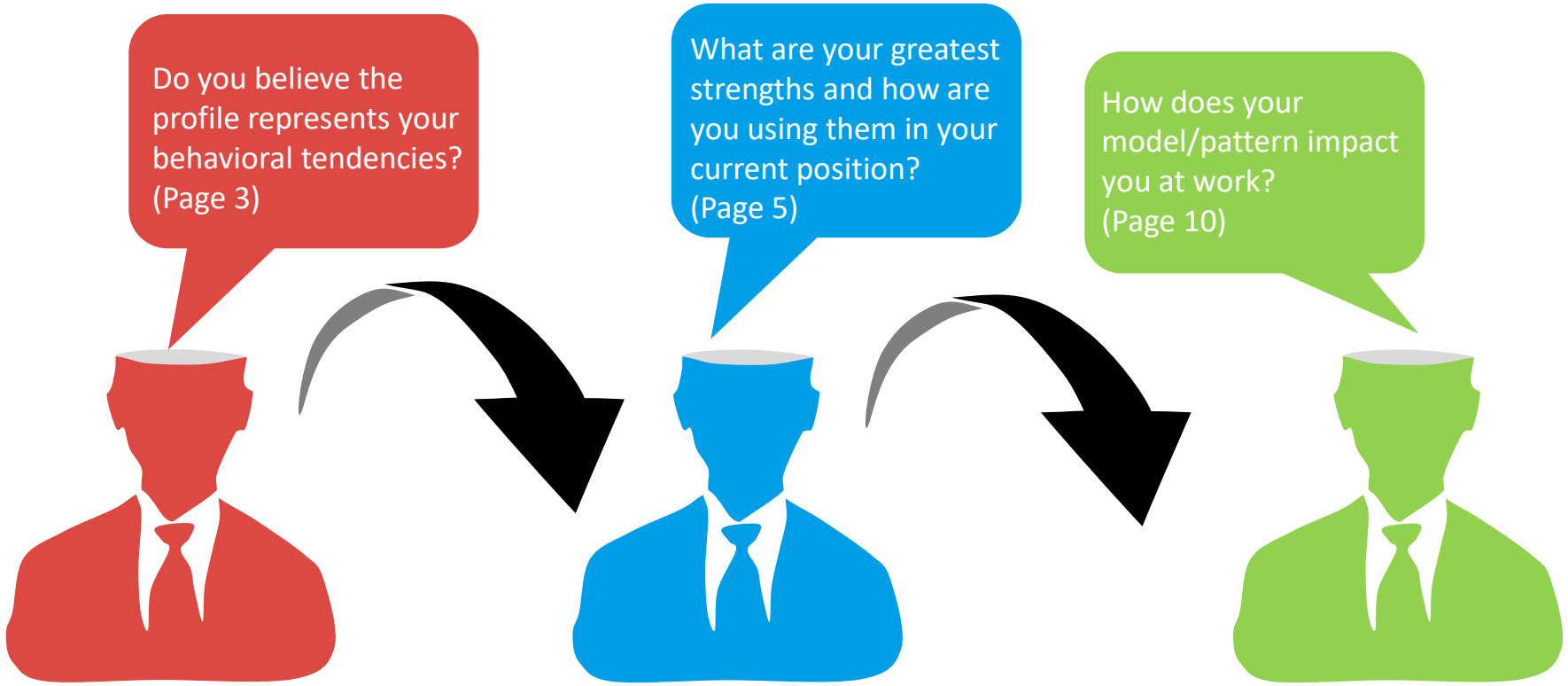
DIGEST, THEN DISCUSS:

- Everyone is going to have 10 minutes to review your profile.
- In small breakout groups (3-4 people) together please discuss the following:



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Report Out

Highlights from groups

Which one of these is TRUE?

The world would be a better place if people were more alike.

Human behavior remains the same in every situation.

People with high D Dimensions of behavior tend to make the best managers.

Descriptions are tendencies not absolutes.

The DISC provides a complete picture of who someone is deep down inside.

The main purpose of DISC is to predict behavior.

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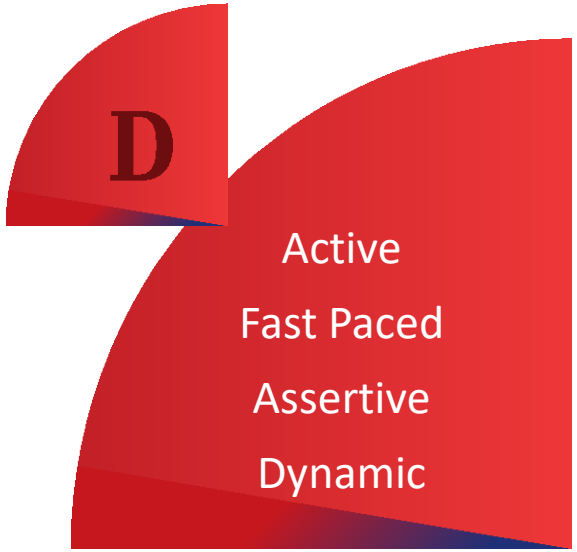
Team Time!

Personal Reflections

1. Describe your style for us.
2. How does your style help you be successful in the workplace?
3. How does your style hinder your success in the workplace?
4. What would you like others to know about your style to make it easier to work with you?
5. Which style do you think presents the most tension for you?
6. How can you adjust your style to more effectively work with other styles?

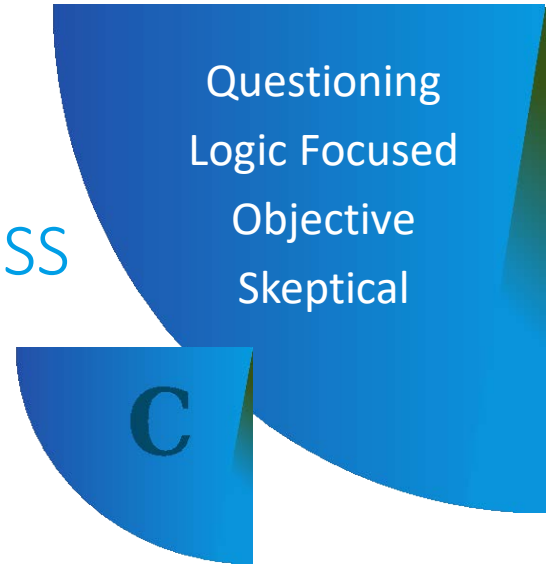
Map Your Team!

DOMINANCE



INFLUENCE

CONSCIENTIOUSNESS



STEADINESS

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What does this tell us about how we work together?

- How are we motivated?
- How do we make decisions?
- How do we tend to communicate?
- Is our team as effective as we could be?
- What are our team strengths?
- What potential blind spots might we have?

Report Out

Highlights from groups

Truly Appreciating Other Perspectives & Styles

- **Extend others the benefit of the doubt:** Assume good intent.
- **Put yourself in the other person's shoes.** Try to imagine if you were that person how you would respond based on your background, context, situation, etc.
- **Consider your motivations:** Consider why you disagree with their action or approach. Is it a selfish motivation or do you have a legitimate concern? Understand your own motives.
- **Stop, Think, React:** When you feel emotional and want to immediately react, step back and ask yourself: ”What just happened? What do I gain by sharing what I'm thinking in this moment?"
- **Seek first to understand, then to be understood.**
- **Create win-win:** When you focus on the mutual win for all concerned the tone will change on your team.

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TIPS FOR WORKING WITH STRONG D TYPES

How to Identify

- Often appears to be in a hurry
- Is direct, says what thinks
- May be blunt
- States own opinions as facts
- Interrupts others
- May talk to many people at the same time
- "What's the bottom line?"
- Is aggressive
- Is demanding
- Very impatient
- Becomes irritated easily

When Communicating

- Be direct and specific
- Provide alternatives
- Disagree only on facts
- Do not be emotional
- Do not dominate
- Allow for the “battle”
- Act quickly, he/she decides fast

Improve Performance (If you are a D)

- Slow down, be more patient
- Do not jump to conclusions or snap decisions
- Listen to others more
- Be more aware how you impact others
- Do not overreact

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TIPS FOR WORKING WITH STRONG I TYPES

How to Identify

- Is open and friendly
- Talks a lot
- Gets easily excited
- Is animated
- Talks about people he/she knows
- Does not focus on details
- Does not listen for long
- Does not pay close attention
- May ask same questions several times
- Jumps from subject to subject
- Stays away from hard facts

When Communicating

- Be friendly, do not ignore
- Schedule time for chatting
- Let him/her speak fully to feel heard
- Give recognition
- Speak about people and feelings
- Remember to follow up

Improve Performance (If you are an I)

- Talk less, listen more
- Do not react emotionally
- Do not over promise
- Focus more on details
- Follow-up

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TIPS FOR WORKING WITH STRONG S TYPES

How to Identify

- Appears calm
- Does not get easily excited
- Listens carefully
- Nods and goes along
- Is easy-going
- Asks questions and inquires about the specifics
- Seems to have strong opinions but does not express them vocally
- Appears thoughtful
- Completely new ideas/things seem to make him/her uncomfortable

When Communicating

- Slow down your presentation
- Build trust
- Focus on people
- Provide the information he/she needs
- Present issues logically
- Secure commitment piece by piece
- Be sincere, do not dominate

Improve Performance (If you are a S)

- Be more assertive and aggressive
- Speak out
- Act now, think less
- Keep your emotions under control
- Do not be afraid of change and new things

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TIPS FOR WORKING WITH STRONG C TYPES

How to Identify

- Appears reserved and somewhat timid
- Is quiet
- Focuses on details
- Asks many questions
- Studies specifications and other information carefully
- Proceeds cautiously
- Doesn't easily express disagreeing views
- May have done homework on the topic
- May be very critical; criticism based on facts, not opinions

When Communicating

- Provide facts
- Be patient, slow down
- Give plenty of detailed information
- Control your own activity
- Do not talk about personal issues
- Do not pressure
- Focus on issues

Improve Performance (If you are a C)

- Talk more
- Decide and take action faster
- Do not be afraid to make mistakes
- Do not lose the big picture
- Accept ambiguity

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Closing Thoughts

Thank You

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